



Samahan Office of the Vice President and the 5th Student Assembly

The official legislative arm of the SAMAHAN.

Assembly Act No. 008-2526

Introduced by **Hon. Ken Ryle “Judge” P. Hinojales**

Authored by **Monica Andrea M. Rama**

**AN ACT ESTABLISHING LEGISLATIVE DEPARTMENTS UNDER THE OFFICE OF
EACH REGULAR VOTING MEMBER OF THE SAMAHAN STUDENT ASSEMBLY
AND THE GRADUAL IMPLEMENTATION OF THE LEGISLATIVE DEPARTMENT -
GENERAL ADMINISTRATIVE CODE.**

ARTICLE I **General Provisions**

SECTION 1 Short Title. This Act shall otherwise be known as the "Legis Launchpad Bill"

SECTION 2 Declaration of Policy. The Samahan ng Mga Mag-Aaral ng Pamantasang Ateneo de Davao (SAMAHAN) acknowledges the vital role of SAMAHAN as a formation-centered student government committed to responding to the concerns and aspirations of the student body. This Act aims to establish Legislative Departments under the office of each Regular Voting Member of the Samahan Student Assembly to be guided and founded by the implementation of the Legislative Department - General Administrative Code. These Legislative Departments stand with SAMAHAN's commitment to serve the student body with compassion, responsiveness, and integrity. In collaboration with the Student Assembly, the Legislative Departments shall strive to address issues concerning the welfare of the student body through legislative endeavors and initiatives. The Department will operate in accordance with its Legislative Department - General Administrative Code and legislate Resolution, Bills, and other legislative technical operations to support its mission.



SECTION 3 Scope. This Act shall apply to the creation, organization, and operational functions of the Legislative Departments under each Regular Voting Member of the SAMAHAN Student Assembly including its roles, responsibilities, and interaction with other SAMAHAN departments, student organizations, and external entities.

SECTION 4 Definition of Terms. For the purposes of this Act, the following terms are defined as follows:

- a. **Legislative Departments:** The legislative arm of each Regular Voting Member of the Samahan Student Assembly as well as for their respective organization. This Act aims to establish such Departments under the office of the Honorable Members within the SAMAHAN Student Assembly.
- b. **“Legis Leads: The Legislative Launchpad”:** A document containing a general administrative outline and implementing rules and regulations for establishing and pioneering legislative offices, departments or committees under the banner of leadership of the office of the Samahan vice president AY 25–26. This document guides the foundation for the Legislative Departments
- c. **LD-AC:** Short title of the “Legis Leads: The Legislative Launchpad” document, also known as the **“Legislative Department - General Administrative Code”**. For brevity, it shall be referred to as the “Legis Dept - Admin Code” or in abbreviated format, “LD-AC.”
- d. **Regular Voting Members** refer to the roster of officers mandated by the Constitution, and convened by the Chairperson, aka the SAMAHAN Vice-President, to form part of the incumbent SA. These are the: (a) SEC External Vice-Presidents, (b) the CCP Chairperson, (c) the Head of Autonomous Commissions, and (d) the Sectoral Representatives – all of whom have been vested with legislative powers to vote upon reviews, rejections, and approvals towards matters presented to the SA.
- e. **Honorable members:** refer to another term for Regular Voting Members, often used within the SAMAHAN Student Assembly during plenary sessions to address each other. Specifically for its use within this Bill, it refers to the following: (a) SEC External Vice-Presidents, (b) the CCP Chairperson, (c) the Head of Autonomous Commissions, and (d) the Sectoral Representatives.
- f. **SEC External Vice-Presidents** refer to one of the constitutionally mandated positions convened by the

Chairperson, aka the SAMAHAN Vice-President, to form part of the SA. They, as an extension of their elected Cluster-Representative, represent the interest and welfare of their respective cluster. They also advise, debate, and lobby in the SA on matters that fall under their cluster's area of specialization.

- g. **Sectoral Representatives** refer to one of the constitutionally mandated positions convened by the Chairperson, aka the SAMAHAN Vice-President, to form part of the SA. They, as the representative of a designated sectoral organization, represent the interest and welfare of their respective sector. They also advise, debate, and lobby in the SA on matters that fall under their sector's area of specialization.
- h. **SAMAHAN Student Assembly**, aka the SA, refers to the legislative department of the SAMAHAN, vested with the legislative powers to review, approve, and reject proposals of new offices, new departments, new projects, and new programs from the Executive Branch, as well as deliberate and vote upon resolutions submitted by any member of the SAMAHAN Central Board or the regular members from the SA. Its composition is outlined by the Amended 2020 SAMAHAN Constitution that includes cluster, sectoral, and commission representatives that's generally chaired and convened by the SAMAHAN Vice-President.

ARTICLE II

Purpose and Other Preliminary Provisions

SECTION 1 Purpose. The purpose of these Legislative Departments is to:

- a. Serve as the legislative arm of each Regular Voting Member of the Samahan Student Assembly as well as function as a Legislative Department for their respective organization.
- b. Guided by the Legislative Department - General Administrative Code, the Legislative Departments aim to support the legislative endeavors of the Honorable Members.
- c. The provisions of the LD-AC are intended to stipulate the mandates and tasks of the Legislative Department Head, Legislative Department Co-Heads, and Legislative Department Members. It shall articulate the goals of the offices and departments and its limits and jurisdictions.

- d. Broaden the scope and manpower of the SAMAHAN Student Assembly in terms of legislative operations.
- e. Uphold the values of service, justice, and integrity in building a community whose concerns are properly addressed through the creation of quality Bills and Resolutions.

SECTION 2 Establishment of Departments. The Legislative Departments are hereby established under each Regular Voting Members organization as a distinct division operating under their respective Voting Member in the SA. Such establishments shall be guided by the LD-AC, modified accordingly by the organization as they deem fit.

SECTION 3 Roles and Responsibilities. The Legislative Departments shall:

- a. Provide administrative, clerical, and procedural technical support relevant to the Student Assembly's legislative operations in coordination with their respective Voting Member in the SA;
- b. Conduct research and surveys on various policy issues and legislative proposals submitted to the SA to ensure informed decision-making and proper consensus upon voting;
- c. Assist in drafting bills, amendments, position papers, privilege speeches, and legislative resolutions that are constitutional, legal, of quality, and holistically sound;
- d. Advise their respective Voting Member on the SA on the parliamentary procedures and legislative mode of proceedings;
- e. Collaborate with other Legislative Departments and student organizations to be responsive to the needs of the student body, at the given capacity of the department.
- f. Maintain an accurate and comprehensive archive of legislative proceedings of the department, including a database of officers, legislative activities, Department reports, narrative reports, and enacted laws;

SECTION 4 Operational Significance. The creation of Legislative Departments represents a continuous and collaborative bond between the Student Assembly, the Regular Voting Member of the SAMAHAN Student Assembly and their constituents, and the student body through legislative undertakings. Guided and founded by the Legislative Department - General Administrative Code, these Legislative Departments are structured to address community concerns through legislation. The department's establishment under their respective Regular Voting Member of the Samahan Student Assembly, ensures

legislative technical support in both its role within the Student Assembly and to their respective organizations. The Legislative Departments will be equipped with the mandate to:

- a. To support their SEC External Vice-President/Sectoral Representative, who are Regular Voting Members in the SAMAHAN Student Assembly, by providing administrative, clerical, and procedural technical support relevant to the SA's legislative operations, monitoring policy, program, and lobbying initiatives, and advising on relevant policy frameworks.
- b. Be structured and guided by the Legislative Department - General Administrative Code whose provisions are intended to stipulate the mandates and tasks of the Legislative Department Head, Legislative Department Co-Heads, and Legislative Department Members. It shall articulate the goals of the offices and departments and its limits and jurisdictions.
- c. Develop partnerships with relevant student organizations, academic institutions, and external stakeholders to amplify the department's reach and effectiveness.
- d. Ensure compliance with all relevant regulations and internal procedures, providing periodic reports to their respective Honorable Member on the department's performance and strategic outcomes.

ARTICLE III **Final Provisions**

SECTION 1 *Repealing Clause.* All other laws, rules, or regulations contrary to or inconsistent with this Act are hereby repealed or modified accordingly.

SECTION 2 *Separability Clause.* If any provision of this Act is held to be invalid or unconstitutional, the remaining provisions shall continue in full force and effect.

SECTION 3 *Standardization and Alignment Provision.* In the event that a similar department or office already exists within the honorable member's organization prior to the enactment of this Act, the provisions herein shall serve as a benchmarking framework to review, modify, or realign the functions, structure, and operations of the existing department, guided by the Legislative Department - General Administrative Code, as the organization deems necessary. In

alignment with this, sectors and organizations who do not have existing legislative departments shall be mandated to establish one, guided by gradual implementation of the Legislative Department - General Administrative Code, which they may modify, or align the functions, structure, and operations as the organization deems necessary.

Approved this 19th Day of December, 2025.

APPROVED BY:

Hon. Angela A. Miel
Business and Management Cluster

Hon. Marc C. Andrei Macoto
Computer Studies Cluster

Hon. Sandra Rachelle Joy C. Adora
Natural Science and Mathematics Cluster

Hon. Jericka Niña Paculaba
School of Education

Hon. Maria Sophia B. Tancinco
School of Nursing

Hon. Sam Gaebryle Montejo
Ateneo Libulan Circle

Hon. Phoemela Alexandra D. Gawilan
Ateneo Lumad Students Organization

Hon. Christian Dave Fernandez
Commission on Audit

Hon. Jiesen Riexen Ferraren
*Protection of Women's Equality and Rights
Representative*

Hon. Wennin Jacob Bouda
International Students Representative

ATTESTED BY:

Hon. Ken Ryle "Judge" P. Hinojales
Chairperson & Convener
5th SAMAHAN Student Assembly

APPROVED:

Hon. Hannah O. Aquino
SAMAHAN President

Signed: December 20, 2025

Exhibit A
Legis Leads: The Legislative Launchpad

**A GENERAL ADMINISTRATIVE OUTLINE AND
IMPLEMENTING RULES AND REGULATIONS FOR
ESTABLISHING AND PIONEERING LEGISLATIVE OFFICES
AND DEPARTMENTS**

Legis Leads: The Legislative Launchpad

Prepared by

MONICA ANDREA M. RAMA
Legislative Secretary
Office of the SAMAHAN Vice-President

GENERAL ADMINISTRATIVE CODE

Legislative Department a Product of the OSVP Legis Launchpad Initiative A.Y. 2025-2026

ARTICLE I GENERAL PROVISIONS

Section 1. Title. - This document shall be known as the “**Legislative Department - General Administrative Code**”. For brevity, it shall be referred to as the “Legis Dept - Admin Code” or in abbreviated format, “LD-AC.”

Section 2. General Definitions. - The following words or text is operationally defined in this code, as follows:

(1) *Student Executive Council/s*, aka SECs, refer to the nine (9) local government units that form part of the executive machinery of the SAMAHAN Central Board, which is unanimously led and represented by an elected cluster representative.

(2) SAMAHAN *Student Assembly*, aka the SA, refers to the legislative department of the SAMAHAN, vested with the legislative powers to review, approve, and reject proposals of new offices, new departments, new projects, and new programs from the Executive Branch, as well as deliberate and vote upon resolutions submitted by any member of the SAMAHAN Central Board or the regular members from the SA. Its composition is outlined by the Amended 2020 SAMAHAN Constitution that includes cluster, sectoral, and commission representatives that’s generally chaired and convened by the SAMAHAN Vice-President.

(3) *Legislative Support and Monitoring Bureau aka LSMB* refers to the primary legislative support arm of the legislative department of SAMAHAN, the SA. Headed by Legislative Support and Monitoring Bureau Director and Deputy Director alongside a Chief Associate for

Legislative Administration, it is composed of (1) Legislative Technical Reference, (2) Congressional Affairs, (3) Plenary Proceedings, (4) Research and Development, and (5) Policy Advisory Officer. They are tasked to provide legislative technical assistance, promote and educate the SA's goals, progress, and legislative operations to the community's stakeholders, monitor and implement approved policies and programs of the SA, and recommend policy frameworks to the SA reinforced by scientific data and research that addresses salient community concerns.

(4) *Regular Voting Members* refer to the roster of officers mandated by the Constitution, and convened by the Chairperson, aka the SAMAHAN Vice-President, to form part of the incumbent SA. These are the: (a) SEC External Vice-Presidents, (b) the CCP Chairperson, (c) Head of Autonomous Commissions and (d) the Sectoral Representatives – all of whom have been vested with legislative powers to vote upon reviews, rejections, and approvals towards matters presented to the SA.

(5) *SEC External Vice-Presidents* refer to one of the constitutionally mandated positions convened by the Chairperson, aka the SAMAHAN Vice-President, to form part of the SA. They, as an extension of their elected Cluster-Representative, represent the interest and welfare of their respective cluster. They also advise, debate, and lobby in the SA on matters that fall under their cluster's area of specialization.

(6) *Sectoral Representatives* refer to one of the constitutionally mandated positions convened by the Chairperson, aka the SAMAHAN Vice-President, to form part of the SA. They, as the official representative of a designated sectoral organization, represent the interest and welfare of their respective sector. They also advise, debate, and lobby in the SA on matters that fall under their sector's area of specialization.

Section 3. Declaration of Goals and Mandates. The provisions of the LD-AC are intended to stipulate the mandates and tasks of the Legislative Department Head, Legislative Department Co-Heads, and

Legislative Department Members. It shall articulate the goals of the offices and departments and its limits and jurisdictions.

Section 4. Implementing Entity. The Legislative Secretary, acting as well as the Legislative Department Head, is called upon to promulgate, uphold, and implement this code.

Section 5. Legal Vinculum. The provisions of the LD-AC are to be regarded by the appointed Legislative Department Director, and the Legislative Department Co-Heads as part and parcel of their duties, and responsibilities to fulfill the executive and legislative mandates of the Legislative Department. Once officially appointed through the publication and dissemination of a memorandum circular of their respective Cluster SEC/Sectoral Organization, they are bound unto this code to support their SEC External Vice-President/Sectoral Representative, who are Regular Voting Members in the SAMAHAN Student Assembly, by providing administrative, clerical, and procedural technical support relevant to the SA's legislative operations, monitoring policy, program, and lobbying initiatives, and advising on relevant policy frameworks.

ARTICLE II THE LEGISLATIVE DEPARTMENT

Section 1. Declaration of Powers. - The legislative powers of the organization/SEC, as its premier legislative arm, is hereby vested into the Legislative Department.

Section 2. Composition. - The Legislative Department of the organization/SEC shall be composed of the following:

2.1 Legislative Director

2.1.1. The Legislative Director shall also serve as the acting Legislative Secretary to the EVP/Sectoral Representative and to the organization.

2.2 Legislative Deputy Director

2.2.1 The Legislative Deputy Director shall also serve as the Policy Implementation Director to the Department

2.3 Chief Associate for Legislative Technical Reference

2.4 Chief Associate for Research and Policy

2.5 Legislative Associates

Section 3. Powers and Responsibilities. - The Legislative Department shall have the following general duties:

3.1 Technical Support - to provide administrative, clerical, and procedural technical support relevant to the Student Assembly's legislative operations in coordination with their respective Voting Member in the SA;

3.2 Research and Analysis - to conduct research and surveys on various policy issues and legislative proposals submitted to the SA to ensure informed decision-making and proper consensus upon voting;

3.3 Legislative Drafting & Review - to assist in drafting bills, amendments, position papers, privilege speeches, and legislative resolutions that are constitutional, legal, of quality, and holistically sound;

3.4 Procedural Guidance - to advise their respective Voting Member on the SA on the parliamentary procedures and legislative mode of proceedings;

3.5 Archiving and Documentation - to maintain an accurate and comprehensive archive of legislative proceedings of the department, including a database of officers, legislative activities, Department reports, narrative reports, and enacted laws;

3.6 Constituency Management - to organize public consultations, hearings, and communication lines for

Regular Voting Members of the SA to their constituents and stakeholders concerning policies and legislative proposals relevant to the SA.

- 3.7 Inter-Agency Collaboration** - to coordinate and facilitate inter-agency collaboration as the primary liaison between the legislative body and various stakeholders ranging to co-implementing bodies, university administrators, external organizations, co-legislators, and the student body

Section 4. The Legislative Director, who is appointed by the organization, shall be the chief legislative officer of the organization/SEC . It shall be their duty to:

- 4.1 Liaison to the Office of the Honorable Members** - to serve as the official legislative secretary of the office of the Honorable Members concerning the legislative operations of the SA and the department. In collaboration with their Sectoral Representative they shall lead in the creation of legislation that aims to address the concerns and issues of the student body they are representing;
- 4.2 Office Management** - to serve as the acting Legislative Department Director and exercise supervision and mobilization over the department's operations, officers, supplies, budget, and morale;
- 4.3 Capacity Building** - to conduct training sessions and workshops to build legislative and technical capacity among co-officers, stakeholders, and units to enhance the overall legislative operations and initiative of the Voting Member and the department;
- 4.4 Technical Support** - to provide administrative, clerical, and procedural technical support relevant to the *Student Assembly's* legislative operations in coordination with their respective Voting Member in the SA;

- 4.5 Legislative Drafting & Review** - to assist in drafting bills, amendments, position papers, privilege speeches, and legislative resolutions that are constitutional, legal, of quality, and holistically sound;
- 4.6 Procedural Guidance** - to advise their respective Voting Member on the SA on the parliamentary procedures and legislative mode of proceedings;
- 4.7 Scheduling and Coordination** - to manage calendars of their respective Regular Voting Member's sessions in the SA including scheduling meetings, appointments, and events.
- 4.8 Record Keeping** - to maintain accurate and comprehensive records of legislative activities, including voting records, bill tracking, and session transcripts.

Section 5. The Legislative Deputy Director ,who is appointed by the organization, shall be the chief policy implementation officer of organization/SEC. It shall be their duty to:

- 5.1 Policy Translation** - to translate legislation, policy frameworks, and position papers into realistic, tangible, and actionable policies or programs in alignment with the organization and the university's goals and missions;
- 5.2 Strategic Planning and Oversight** - to develop and oversee effective implementation strategies for legislative policies, programs, or initiatives in alignment with the organization and the university's goals and missions;
- 5.3 Stakeholder Coordination** - to facilitate inter-agency collaboration as the primary liaison between the legislative body and various stakeholders ranging to co-implementing bodies, university administrators, external organizations, co-legislators, and the student body;

- 5.4 Monitoring and Evaluation** - to establish comprehensive metrics, and time-sensitive evaluations systems for monitoring the progress and gauging the impact of the implemented policy program, or initiative;
- 5.5 Legislative Updates** - to provide expedient legislative changes and updates that may impact implementation to the Legislative Secretary and their respective Voting Member, and appropriately advise changes on the implications of such in the implementation process;
- 5.6 Risk Management** - to identify potential risks and obstacles to effective policy implementation and in response, develop and implement mitigation strategies to address these risks;
- 5.7 Compliance to Legalities and Constitutionalities** - to ensure that implementation activities comply with legislative mandates and regulatory requirements;
- 5.8 Conflict Resolution** - to mediate and resolve conflicts between co-officers, stakeholders, and co-implementing agencies that may arise during the implementation process;
- 5.9 Reporting** - to prepare and present detailed reports on implementation progress to the legislative body and other relevant stakeholders if it is deemed necessary.

Section 6. The Chief Associate for Legislative Technical Reference, who is appointed by the organization, shall be the chief technical operations officer of organization/SEC. It shall be their duty to:

- 6.1 Quality Control** - to ensure the accuracy and integrity of technical information used in legislative proposals ranging from grammatical conventions, constitutionality, legalities, and other technicalities deemed necessary to conform to for soundness;
- 6.2 Legislation Review** - to review drafted bills, amendments, and resolutions for technical soundness and feasibility;

- 6.3 Resource Development** - to gather, analyze, and curate technical data and information from various sources that shall ensure their respective Voting Members have access to a library of reliable and comprehensive technical resources;
- 6.4 Resource Management** - to manage databases and repositories of technical information relevant to legislative operations of the SA and the committee/department ranging from a database of officers, legislative activities, minutes of session debates, dispersion of votes, Department reports, narrative reports, and enacted laws;
- 6.5 Policy Development and Implementation Support** - to support the development of evidence-based policies by integrating technical knowledge through collaborating with policy experts, co-legislators, and relevant stakeholders;

Section 7. Chief Associate for Research and Policy who is appointed by the organization, shall be the chief sectoral adviser of the Legislative Department of the organization/SEC. It shall be their duty to:

- 7.1 Technical Expertise** - to serve as the primary resource expert ,within the department, on sectoral trends, issues, and challenges salient to the SA, their respective SEC/sector, the University, or the Philippines as a whole;
- 7.2 Agenda Adviser** - to advise their Voting Member and committee/department on sector-specific policies, legislations, and programs, and in turn, provide strategic guidance on sectoral priorities and agenda
- 7.3 Policy Recommendation** - to formulate clear, actionable sector-specific policy recommendations based on present trends, research, and data concerning the respective SEC/sector, the University, or the Philippines as a whole in collaboration with the existing sectoral officers within the organization;

Section 8. Legislative Associates, who shall be recruited by the Legislative Director, will be composed of any additional member to the department. They shall work directly under the oversight of either Chief Associate for Legislative Technical Reference and Chief Associate for Research and Policy. It shall be their duty to:

8.1 Operational support: to support the Chief Associate for Legislative Technical Reference and Chief Associate for Research and Policy respectively, in legislation and data gathering.

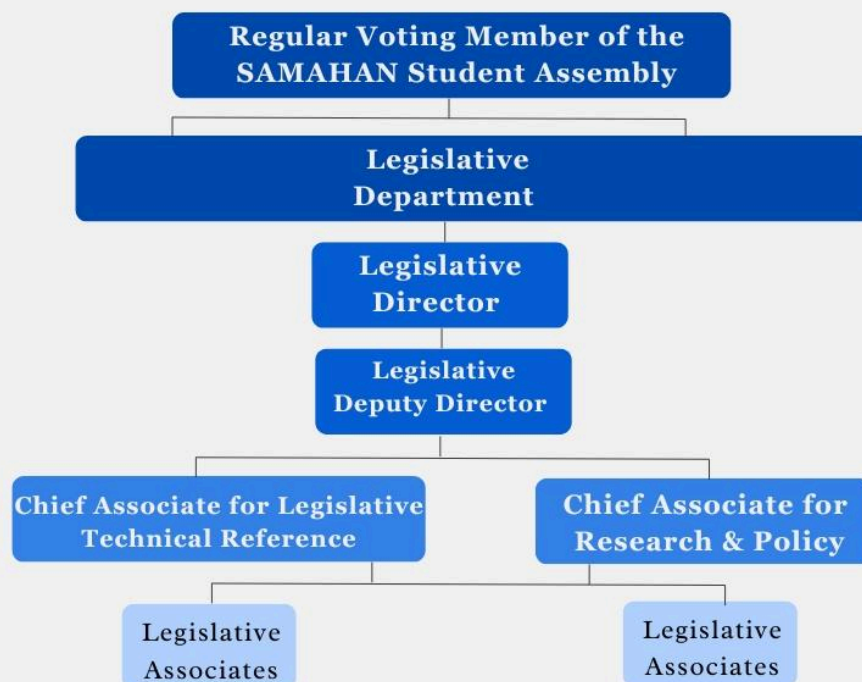
8.2 Capacity Building: to actively participate in efforts to broaden their knowledge in legislation by involving themselves in projects initiated by their department.

Section 9. The Legislative Department whose members are appointed by the organization, shall follow the chain of command represented in **Section 9.1 and Annex A.**

9.1. Chain of Command: The Legislative Department shall be under their respective representative who is a voting member of the SAMAHAN student assembly. The Legislative Department shall be headed by the Legislative Director, whose second shall be the Legislative Deputy Director. The Department will also be composed of a Chief Associate for Legislative Technical Reference and a Chief Associate for Research and Policy. Additional Members to the department will be regarded as Legislative Associates. This chain of command is represented in **Annex A.**

ANNEX A

LEGIS LEADS: THE LEGISLATIVE LAUNCHPAD



AUTHOR'S CLOSING NOTE

November 25, 2025

I am grateful to have had the opportunity to create this IRR for the purpose of future legislative endeavors of the Ateneo Community. This document shall serve as a template and administrative outline for future legislative committees and departments under every student sector represented in the Student Assembly and beyond. I thank everyone involved in this journey. Under the leadership of *Ken Ryle Hinojales* the SAMAHAN Vice President of Academic Year 25-26, whose administration this Legislative Launchpad shall be accomplished. Through my first mentor *Daniel Dave P. Gomez* the former SAMAHAN Vice-President Academic Year 23-24, who has played a major role in the existence of this IRR and to whom I dedicate this document to.

Like all things new, such committees created from this IRR will start off like a budding flower – small and simple – and through time will grow into something beautiful and complex. Though these structures may change and evolve, I implore that it should always be used for goodness and kindness. May every student leader have it in their heart to prioritize the welfare of the student body and to be led by God. It is with pride and honor that I pass this torch of legislation with steadfast faith and integrity to my fellow Ateneans and generations of students to come. I look forward to the future of promise that this document will inspire.

Who, with loving eagerness. Send you luck and happiness.

~ In love and gratitude,
Monica Andrea M. Rama